Colour frequency and phototherapy

Muted yellow or amber light can recall a candle, an autumn afternoon or the sun on a table. It can create a **kinder** atmosphere than a harshly lit room. Let us say which of that is **atmosphere** and which is already **treatment**.

And this is exactly where it is good to put miraculous promises aside. Yellow light is not a magic lamp for hormones, mood or chakras.

Why warm light can be pleasant in the evening

Warm light contains little of the blue component and tends to be softer than cool white. In the evening it is easy to slow down in it. Less glare, gentler contrasts. For an evening routine, though, it is not only the shade that matters. It also depends on the brightness, the length of time the light is on and how much light falls into the eyes. A very bright yellow lamp right in front of your face is not automatically more suitable than a weak warm light out of direct view.

What you can try at home

In the evening switch off the large ceiling light and leave a smaller lamp on with a warm, muted light. So that you can see well and do not have to strain your eyes. **What it can bring you.** Less glare and an environment in which it is easier to move from activity to a calmer evening. During the day, on the other hand, do not shut yourself into a yellow half-light with the idea that it is beneficial in all circumstances. Daylight and evening quiet have different places in an ordinary day.

Where light is really studied

Blue-light glasses

Glasses that filter blue light (sometimes amber-tinted) are often offered, promising better sleep or less eye strain. A 2023 Cochrane review summarising 17 randomised trials, however, concluded that the evidence is inconclusive. For eye strain from computers there seems to be no short-term benefit, for sleep the effect is unclear. The studies did not assess long-term effects on the retina.

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Skin

Yellow and amber LED light around 590 nm penetrates the skin only about 0.5 to 2 millimetres and is studied mainly in skin ageing and as an adjunct after laser procedures. Smaller clinical studies follow, for example, sensitive skin, redness and the skin barrier, but the results are inconsistent. The results of a specific device and procedure cannot be transferred to every home lamp. If such treatment interests you, discuss its suitability with a dermatologist or another health professional experienced with the method.

Seasonal depression

For some difficulties light therapy is genuinely used, for example bright white light for seasonal depression. It is not a matter of surrounding yourself with the colour yellow or buying an ordinary yellow bulb. The choice of approach is guided by the specific problem, not by a favourite colour, and belongs in the hands of a doctor, especially with eye problems, certain medicines or bipolar disorder.

Yellow can delight you as a colour. Therapeutic light is judged by its specific purpose and parameters.

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